

Music Career — Deep Plan

Month-by-Month Action Guide • August 2026 – July 2027 • Jeffrey Bickish

This plan is built for **4–8 hours per week** of focused effort starting August 2026, with vocal training complete. Your home recording setup (Focusrite interface + condenser mic + DAW) and catalog of 13–20 original songs means you can go faster than most. The strategy is **content and platform first** — a strong YouTube channel, website, email list, and Spotify presence — with gigging as a supplement, not the focus. Year 1 ends with a released single, a completed EP, and an established online home.

Big Picture Timeline

Milestone	Target Date	What It Means
Vocal training complete	July 2026	You're performance & recording ready
Platform setup complete (website, YouTube, email, DistroKid)	Aug–Sept 2026	Your online home is live before any releases
First Single released	Nov 2026	Your first song on Spotify/Apple Music
YouTube: 10 videos published	Nov 2026	Enough content to look established
Email list: 50 subscribers	Dec 2026	First real audience milestone
EP recording complete	Feb–Mar 2027	All 4–5 songs tracked and rough-mixed
EP mixed & mastered	April 2027	Ready to submit to distribution
EP released	May 2027	Full debut release — right at Sandpoint summer
YouTube: 100 subscribers	June 2027	Small but real momentum
First local gig using EP as credential	June–July 2027	Now you have something to show venues
Year 1 review & Year 2 plan	July 2027	Assess, adapt, and scale

Platform Strategy & Setup

Based on your preference for depth over breadth, here's the recommended platform priority. You don't need to be everywhere — you need to be solid in a few places.

Platform	Priority	Your Goal	Cost	When to Set Up
YouTube	PRIMARY	Long-form acoustic videos, EP behind-the-scenes, song stories. Best long-term discovery engine for folk.	Free	Month 1 (Aug)

Platform	Priority	Your Goal	Cost	When to Set Up
Website (Bandzoogle)	PRIMARY	Your permanent home. Bio, music, press kit, email sign-up, merch later.	\$10/mo	Month 1 (Aug)
Email List (MailerLite)	PRIMARY	Most valuable asset long-term. Even 200 real fans bears fruit.	Free	Month 1 (Aug)
DistroKid	PRIMARY	Gets your music to Spotify, Apple Music, YouTube Music, Amazon, etc.	\$2/mo	Month 1 (Aug)
Spotify for Artists	PRIMARY	Claim your artist profile, submit to editorial playlists, track analytics.	Free	After 1st release
Instagram	LIGHT	Occasional posts — a clip here, a behind-the-scenes there.	Free	Month 2 (Sept)
TikTok	OPTIONAL	Only if a video naturally performs well. Don't force it.	Free	Month 3+ if at all
Bandcamp	SECONDARY	Folk fans love Bandcamp. Great for EP sales + tips. Set up a fan page.	\$1.50 fee	Month 10 (May)

PRIMARY = set up immediately and maintain. LIGHT = occasional, low effort. OPTIONAL = only if organic.

Year 1 — Month by Month Task Guide

Each month assumes **4–8 hours/week** (16–32 hours/month). Tasks are grouped by category. ■ = to-do item | ■ = milestone/deliverable | ★ = important note or tip

MONTH 1

August 2026

— Foundation —
Build Your Digital
Home

Est. 4–6 hrs/wk

CATALOG & CREATIVE

- Listen through all 13–20 original songs — take notes on which feel most finished
- Create a simple spreadsheet: Song title | Status | Notes | Single candidate? (Y/N)
- Identify your top 3 SINGLE CANDIDATES — most accessible, emotionally clear, ~3 min
- Record rough phone/scratch demos of those 3 finalists (just for your ears)
- Choose your ARTIST NAME — legal name (Jeffrey Bickish) or a stage name — decide now

★ *This decision affects all platform setup below — lock it in before creating accounts*

PLATFORM SETUP

- **Sign up for DistroKid (\$22/yr) — don't upload anything yet, just get the account ready**
- **Sign up for Bandzoogle (\$10/mo) — start from a basic template**
- Set up 5 website pages: Home, Music (empty for now), About, Shows, Contact
- Write your short artist bio (100 words): who you are, where you're from, your sound
- Write your long artist bio (250 words): add your story, influences, Sandpoint roots
- Source or shoot a basic artist photo — outdoors, natural light, guitar optional
- **Sign up for MailerLite (free) — create your first email list called 'My Audience'**
- Add email signup form to your website — put it on the Home page AND the Music page
- **Create your YouTube channel — use your artist name, fill out the About section fully**
- Upload your channel icon (your artist photo) and create a simple channel banner (Canva)
- Create an Instagram account with your artist name — profile photo + 1-line bio only

★ *Don't post anything yet — just claim the handle before someone else does*

FIRST YOUTUBE VIDEO

- **Film and upload your very first YouTube video — a simple single-camera acoustic performance**
- Pick any original song — doesn't have to be your single. Just break the ice.
- Good setup: natural window light, phone or camera, your best-sounding room
- Title format: '[Song Name] — Jeffrey Bickish (Acoustic Folk)'
- Write a real description: who you are, where you're from, what the song is about

★ *Don't wait for perfect. Imperfect and real beats polished and delayed every time.*

MONTH 2

September 2026

— Choose Your
Single — Start
Recording

Est. 5–7 hrs/wk

SINGLE SELECTION & ARRANGEMENT

- **Choose your first single — commit to ONE song by end of this week**
- Write out the full chord chart and arrangement map (intro/verse/chorus/bridge/outro)
- Decide on instrumentation: solo guitar+vocals only? Or add light percussion, harmony?
- Practice the song to death — at least 20 run-throughs before recording
- Set up your recording space: quiet room, rugs/soft surfaces to reduce echo
- Do a test recording in your DAW — just to check levels, room sound, mic placement
- Experiment with mic placement: 12th fret vs soundhole vs 45-degree angle
- ★ *Microphone placement matters more than almost anything else for acoustic guitar*

RECORD THE SINGLE

- **Record 3–5 full takes of your single (guitar + vocals together or separately)**
- Option A — Together: More natural feel, harder to fix mistakes
- Option B — Separately: Tighter control, more editing flexibility
- Listen back on headphones AND laptop speakers — both matter
- Pick your best full take as the BASE — don't over-comp
- If adding harmony: record 1–2 harmony tracks on the chorus only
- If adding light percussion (cajon, shaker): keep it minimal and supportive
- Save all sessions with clear file names: SingleName_v1_main.wav etc.

CONTENT & PLATFORM

- Post YouTube video #2 — another original or a brief 'what I'm working on' clip
- Post YouTube video #3 — consider a cover of a well-known folk song (helps discoverability)
- ★ *Covers of known songs bring in new listeners; originals convert them to fans*
- Add a 'Something is coming...' teaser line to your website home page
- Send your FIRST EMAIL to your list — introduce yourself, link to your YouTube
- Keep the email warm and personal: 'Hey, I'm Jeffrey. Here's what I'm up to...'

MONTH 3

October 2026

— Mix, Master &
Prep for Release

Est. 5–7 hrs/wk

MIXING THE SINGLE

- **Do your rough mix in your DAW — get vocal and guitar balanced first**
- EQ checklist for acoustic guitar: high-pass at 80Hz, small boost at 2–5kHz for clarity
- EQ checklist for vocals: high-pass at 100Hz, presence boost at 3–5kHz, de-ess if needed
- Add light reverb to vocals (room or plate, short decay — folk stays dry)
- Add subtle reverb to guitar (just enough to sit in space)
- Check your mix in mono — if it sounds good in mono it'll sound good everywhere
- Option: Hire an online mixer via Fiverr or SubmitHub (\$50–\$150) if budget allows
- ★ *Do NOT over-produce. Acoustic folk should sound like a real room, not a studio pop track*

MASTERING

- **Master the single — use LANDR.com (\$9/mo auto-mastering) OR hire for \$30–60**
- Target loudness: -14 LUFS for streaming (Spotify/Apple auto-normalize anyway)
- Export final master as 24-bit WAV (DistroKid accepts WAV or FLAC)
- Listen on 3 different devices: headphones, laptop speakers, phone speaker
- Make one final level check — is the vocal sitting on top without being harsh?

RELEASE PREP

- **Create your single cover art — 3000x3000px minimum (Canva works fine to start)**
- Cover art guidelines: readable at thumbnail size, your name + song title visible
- Get a good artist photo if you haven't — this will be used everywhere for a year
- **Upload single to DistroKid — set release date 3 WEEKS from submission date**
- Release date recommendation: first or second Tuesday of November
- In DistroKid: add ISRC codes (auto-generated), choose all platforms, set release date
- **Submit to Spotify editorial playlists via Spotify for Artists — must be 7+ days before release**
- Write your pitch: genre (acoustic folk/Americana), mood (intimate, reflective), instruments
- Create a pre-save link for your single (DistroKid has this built in)
- Post YouTube video #4 — ideally a 'behind the single' or raw recording session clip

MONTH 4

November 2026

— RELEASE DAY —
Single Launch

Est. 5–7 hrs/wk

RELEASE WEEK

- **RELEASE DAY** — your single is live on Spotify, Apple Music, YouTube Music, and 30+ others
- **Send your release announcement email to your list — keep it personal and excited**
- Email subject line idea: 'It's out — my first single' (simple beats clever)
- Post YouTube video #5 — a dedicated acoustic performance video of the single
- Post on Instagram: simple photo + caption about the release + streaming link
- Share the Spotify link in your YouTube community tab or video description
- ★ *Ask people directly to follow you on Spotify and save the song — it helps the algorithm*
- Text or message a handful of close friends/family personally — not just a mass post

POST-RELEASE PUSH (weeks 2–4)

- Submit single to independent playlist curators via SubmitHub (\$15–30 for 10–15 curators)
- Target playlists: 'acoustic folk', 'singer-songwriter', 'indie folk', 'Americana'
- Reach out to Sandpoint Reader — email the arts editor with a brief pitch + streaming link
- Google 'acoustic folk music blogs' — email 3–5 smaller blogs with a personal pitch
- Post YouTube video #6 — a cover of a folk classic (fingerpicking or strumming)
- Post YouTube video #7 — a 'story behind the song' video for your single
- Check Spotify for Artists: streams, saves, listener locations — note what you see
- ★ *Saves (heart icon) matter more than streams for Spotify's algorithm*

EP PRE-PRODUCTION STARTS

- **Choose your EP track list — 4 or 5 songs including or adjacent to the single**
- Recommended EP structure: opener (energetic), 2 mid-tempo tracks, 1 slow/emotional, closer
- Create arrangement sheets for each EP track: key, tempo, chord chart, structure
- Record scratch demos of each EP song (phone recording is fine — just capture ideas)
- Make note of instrumentation ideas for each track — what serves the song?

MONTH 5

December 2026

— EP

Pre-Production +
Year-End Content

Est. 4–5 hrs/wk

EP PLANNING

■ **Finalize EP song order — listen to all 4–5 rough demos in sequence, does it flow?**

■ Write out detailed production notes for each track: what makes it special? What does it need?

■ Decide on your EP title — could be a lyric, a place name, a feeling. Don't overthink it yet.

■ Set your recording schedule for Jan–Feb — block out specific sessions per song

■ Decide: record all tracks solo guitar+vocal? Or will any tracks have added elements?

★ *Less is more on a debut EP. Spare arrangements record faster and often sound better.*

HOLIDAY CONTENT

■ Post YouTube video #8 — a holiday or winter-themed original OR an acoustic holiday cover

■ Holiday covers perform very well in December (searches spike 300–500%)

■ Keep it in your folk style — don't force a genre you're not comfortable in

■ Post YouTube video #9 — a year-end wrap or 'what I'm working on in 2027' video

★ *Personal 'update' videos build connection with your audience. Authenticity > production*

■ Send a year-end email to your list — thank them, tease the EP coming in 2027

PLATFORM MAINTENANCE

■ Review YouTube analytics: which video got the most views? Most watch time? Note it.

■ Update your website: add your single to the Music page with Spotify embed

■ Make sure your email signup is prominent on every page of your website

■ Add a link-in-bio tool to Instagram (Linktree or Beacons — free) linking to Spotify + YouTube

■ Check DistroKid dashboard: make sure royalties are routing to your bank account

■ Register with a PRO if you haven't: ASCAP (\$50 one-time) or BMI (free) — do this NOW

★ *ASCAP or BMI registers your songs for performance royalties. You cannot retroactively claim.*

MONTH 6

January 2027

— EP Recording —
Tracks 1 & 2

Est. 5–7 hrs/wk

RECORDING

■ Record EP Track 1 — full guitar + vocal, plus any overdubs

■ Session structure: 1 hr setup/warmup → 2 hrs tracking → 1 hr rough listen/notes

■ Record 3–4 takes minimum, pick the best, comp only if needed

■ Record EP Track 2 — repeat process

■ Export rough mixes of tracks 1 & 2 at end of month — just to hear them on a phone

★ *Don't mix as you go. Track everything first, mix last. It's faster and sounds better.*

■ Save your DAW sessions with version numbers:

EP_Track1_Jan15_v2.logicx

CONTENT

■ Post YouTube video #10 — you now have 10 videos: a real channel milestone

■ Post YouTube video #11 — 'I'm recording my EP' update (show the mic, the interface, your space)

■ Keep it low-key and real — people love watching someone create something

■ Post 1–2 Instagram clips — short acoustic snippets are fine

■ Send an email to your list: 'EP recording has started — here's what's coming'

BUSINESS

■ Confirm your ASCAP or BMI registration is complete — register each song you've released

■ Set up a simple spreadsheet to track: Spotify monthly listeners, YouTube subs, email list size

■ Log these numbers on the 1st of every month — you'll want this data later

■ Research sync licensing basics — watch 1–2 YouTube videos on how it works

■ Platforms to explore: Musicbed, Artlist, Pond5, Music Vine — just read their submission pages for now

MONTH 7

February 2027

— EP Recording —

Tracks 3, 4 & 5

Est. 5–7 hrs/wk

RECORDING

■ Record EP Track 3

■ Record EP Track 4

■ Record EP Track 5 (if 5-song EP) — or use this time to re-record anything from tracks 1–4

■ Do a raw playback session: play all rough mixes in sequence, take notes on each

■ Note: What's the loudest moment? The quietest? Does the EP breathe and move?

■ Identify any tracks that need additional recording (harmony, re-take, added element)

■ All tracking complete by end of February — this is a key milestone

★ *If you're not happy with a take, re-record it now. Mixing can't fix a bad performance.*

CONTENT

■ Post YouTube video #12 — acoustic performance of a song that DIDN'T make the EP (draw from your deep catalog)

■ Post YouTube video #13 — behind-the-scenes recording clip, even 60 seconds of watching you track

■ Maintain 1 video every 10–14 days minimum — consistency matters more than volume

■ Email update: 'Almost done tracking — EP release coming this spring'

DISTRIBUTION PREP

■ Decide on EP title (deadline: end of this month)

■ Start concept for EP cover art — sketch ideas, find reference images you like

■ Option: hire a local Sandpoint photographer for EP photo shoot (\$75–150)

■ Option: use Canva with a strong design concept (clean, folk-aesthetic)

■ Write 2–3 sentence descriptions for each EP track (for website, DistroKid, press kit)

MONTH 8

March 2027

— Mix All EP Tracks

Est. 6–8 hrs/wk

MIXING

■ **Begin mixing EP Track 1 — start here because you'll learn what works**

■ Mixing order recommendation: start with your most complex track, not the simplest

■ Use reference tracks — listen to a professionally mixed acoustic folk album you love

■ Check: are all vocals sitting above the guitar? Is nothing harsh at 3–5kHz?

■ **Mix EP Track 2**

■ **Mix EP Track 3**

■ **Mix EP Track 4**

■ **Mix EP Track 5**

■ Take breaks while mixing — your ears fatigue. 90 mins on, 30 mins off.

★ *Export each mix as 24-bit WAV. Keep your sessions. Never delete raw tracks.*

■ Option: Hire a mixer on Fiverr for \$50–\$150/track if you want a professional ear

CONTENT

■ Post YouTube video #14 — a reflective or story-driven performance video

■ Post YouTube video #15 — consider a 'what gear I use' or 'my home studio setup' video

★ *Gear/studio videos get solid search traffic and attract fellow musicians to your channel*

■ Send an email update: 'Mixing the EP — release date announcement coming soon'

■ Start building EP release buzz: 'EP drops this spring' in all descriptions/bios

COVER ART & PRESS KIT

■ **Finalize EP cover art — get it to 3000x3000px, print-ready**

■ **Build your EP press kit (1–2 page PDF): artist bio, EP title, track list, cover art, streaming links placeholder**

■ Write your EP one-sheet: a short paragraph describing the EP's sound and themes

■ Update your website: add a 'Coming Soon' EP section with the cover art

★ *A press kit makes you look professional when reaching out to blogs, playlists, and venues*

MONTH 9

April 2027

— Master, Submit &
Build Release Hype

Est. 6–8 hrs/wk

MASTERING

- **Master all EP tracks — use LANDR or hire (\$20–50/track)**
- Check mastered tracks against your streaming references — do they translate?
- Listen to the full EP start to finish on 3 devices: headphones, car, laptop
- Make final adjustments — loudness consistency across all tracks is key
- ★ *Your EP should feel like one cohesive listening experience, not 5 separate songs*
- **Export all final masters as 24-bit WAV at 44.1kHz**

DISTRIBUTION & RELEASE SETUP

- **Upload EP to DistroKid — set release date 3–4 weeks out (target: early May)**
- Upload all tracks, cover art, track descriptions, and metadata
- Choose a release date: first or second Tuesday in May 2027
- **Submit lead EP single to Spotify editorial (must be 7+ days before release)**
- Create pre-save link via DistroKid for the EP
- **Create a Bandcamp page — upload EP for \$7+ name-your-price (folk fans use Bandcamp)**
- Set up your Spotify for Artists profile with EP bio and artist pick

RELEASE CAMPAIGN

- **Email your list: EP announcement with release date and pre-save link**
- Post YouTube video #16 — official EP announcement video (performance + talking to camera)
- Post YouTube video #17 — full acoustic performance of one EP track as a preview
- Post on Instagram: EP cover art reveal
- Submit EP to 15–20 playlist curators on SubmitHub (\$20–30)
- Email 3–5 acoustic folk blogs with press kit and streaming preview link
- Reach out to Sandpoint Reader about a local 'musician releasing debut EP' feature
- ★ *Local press story = real credibility. One article in the Reader is worth 50 Instagram posts.*

MONTH 10

May 2027

— EP RELEASE —

Your Debut is Live

Est. 5–7 hrs/wk

RELEASE WEEK

- **EP RELEASE DAY** — all 4–5 tracks live on Spotify, Apple Music, Bandcamp, and everywhere
 - **Send your EP release email** — personal, warm, direct link to listen
 - Email subject idea: 'My debut EP is out today'
 - Post YouTube video #18 — EP release day acoustic performance (your favorite track)
 - Post Instagram: release day post with cover art + caption
 - Text close friends and family personally with the link — individual messages, not group text
- ★ *Ask your email list to share with one person who might enjoy it. Organic sharing > ads.*

POST-RELEASE MOMENTUM

- Post YouTube video #19 — full performance of a second EP track
 - Post YouTube video #20 — behind the EP: the story of making it, shown simply
 - Send follow-up email week 2: share early listener reactions or a favorite moment from recording
 - Submit EP to more curators: indie folk, Pacific Northwest music blogs, Idaho music press
 - Sandpoint Farmers Market season is open — apply if you haven't (or show up as a listener)
- ★ *You now have a real EP. This is your credential for every venue outreach from here on.*

GIGGING BEGINS (optional, now you're ready)

- Begin reaching out to Pend d'Oreille Winery and Eichardt's Pub with your EP and press kit
- Use your intro email template (from Venue Guide) — now link to your EP and YouTube
- Book a simple EP 'release show' — could be a house concert, a café, or a free outdoor set
- A release show doesn't have to be a paid gig — it's a celebration and a content opportunity

MONTH 11

June 2027

— *Build on
Momentum + First
Gigs*

Est. 4–6 hrs/wk

**CONTENT — PEAK
SEASON**

- Summer = peak discovery season. Keep YouTube consistent: 1 video every 10 days
- Post YouTube video #21 — an outdoor performance video (Sandpoint setting is perfect content)
- Post YouTube video #22 — a cover of a well-known folk song with your arrangement
- Post YouTube video #23 — a deeper dive into songwriting: 'how I wrote [song]'
- ★ *Outdoor performance videos with a beautiful Sandpoint/lake backdrop perform extremely well*

**SYNC LICENSING —
START SUBMITTING**

- **Create an account on Musichbed.com — read their submission guidelines thoroughly**
- **Create an account on Artlist.io — different catalog, worth submitting to both**
- Submit 2–3 of your strongest EP tracks to each platform
- Write metadata carefully: mood tags (reflective, hopeful, melancholic), tempo, instruments
- ★ *Sync licensing is slow to pay off but fully passive once placed. Start the clock now.*
- Catalog every song you've ever written with: title, key, tempo, mood, status — builds your sync library

GIGGING

- Aim for 1–2 booked gigs this month — Farmers Market, winery, café
- Film your live performances — even on a phone. You'll use this content for weeks
- After each gig: talk to people. Collect emails for your list if anyone asks how to follow you
- Start a simple setlist document — which songs work live? Which need work?

ANALYTICS CHECK

- Monthly numbers log: YouTube subs, Spotify monthly listeners, email list size, streams
- Which EP track is getting the most Spotify streams? That's your marketing priority.
- Which YouTube video got the most views? Make more content like that.

MONTH 12

July 2027

— Year 1 Review +
Plan Year 2

Est. 3–5 hrs/wk

YEAR 1 REVIEW

- Pull all your Year 1 numbers: total Spotify streams, YouTube subscribers, email list size, gig count
 - Calculate rough income earned from all sources (streaming, gigs, Bandcamp, tips)
 - Review your 20+ YouTube videos — which 3 performed best? Why?
 - Review your email list — what emails got opened most?
 - Write a honest assessment: what worked, what didn't, what surprised you
- ★ *Most musicians quit in year 1. You finishing this plan means you're already ahead of 90% of starters.*

YEAR 2 PLANNING

- Decide your Year 2 focus: more singles? A full album? Doubling down on YouTube?
- Set new targets: YouTube subscribers, Spotify monthly listeners, email list size, income
- Year 2 realistic targets: 200–500 YouTube subs, 500–2K Spotify monthly listeners, 150–300 email subscribers
- Map out your next 3 releases — singles, covers, or EP tracks as individual releases
- Research online music communities: folk subreddits, acoustic guitar forums, local Facebook groups
- Evaluate whether to hire a part-time social media helper or keep doing it yourself

CELEBRATE

- You released a single AND an EP in one year while working 4–8 hours a week
 - You built a real website, a YouTube channel, an email list, and a streaming presence
 - You are an independent recording artist. Act like it.
- ★ *Take a week off. Seriously. Burnout kills more music careers than anything else.*

Year 2–3 Quarterly Roadmap

By Year 2 you have credentials — a released EP, real online presence, and local reputation. The strategy shifts from building to growing and diversifying income.

Period	Focus	Key Goals
Q1 2028 (Aug–Oct '27)	Release singles from deep catalog	Release 2 new singles off your existing catalog. Each release = a YouTube moment + playlist
Q2 2028 (Nov–Jan '28)	YouTube growth + community	Reach 250 YouTube subscribers. Start a consistent series: 'Songs from Sandpoint' or 'Week
Q3 2028 (Feb–Apr '28)	Second EP or mini-album	Produce and begin recording your second project. Apply to 2–3 Pacific Northwest region
Q4 2028 (May–Jul '28)	Regional gig expansion	Add Coeur d'Alene and Spokane to your gig circuit. Email list target: 200 subscribers. YouTu
Year 3 2028–2029	Monetize & scale	YouTube ad revenue begins. Sync licensing placements start paying. Online lesson offering

Master Setup Checklist — Do This Before Anything Else

	Tool / Service	Why It Matters	Priority
	ASCAP or BMI registration (free–\$50/yr)	Register as a songwriter. Log every song you release.	Set Up First
	DistroKid account (\$22/yr)	Your music distribution pipeline to all streaming platforms.	Set Up First
	Bandzoogle website (~\$10/mo)	Your permanent online home. Use the musician-specific templates.	Set Up First
	MailerLite email list (free)	The single most valuable long-term audience asset.	Set Up First
	YouTube channel (free)	Primary video platform. Folk/acoustic content thrives here.	Set Up First
	Instagram account (free)	Claim your handle. Post occasionally. Don't stress it.	Set Up First
	Spotify for Artists (free)	Claim after your first DistroKid release. Enables editorial submissions.	At Release
	Apple Music for Artists (free)	Claim after first release. Provides useful listener data.	At Release
	Bandcamp page (free, 15% fee)	Set up at EP release. Folk audience loves Bandcamp.	At Release
	Canva account (free)	Cover art, YouTube banners, social graphics. The free tier is enough.	Set Up First
	LANDR mastering (~\$9/mo)	Auto-mastering that's genuinely good for acoustic/folk. Use monthly.	Set Up First
	SubmitHub account (paid per submission)	Submit to playlists and blogs. Budget \$20–30 per release.	At Release
	Linktree or Beacons (free)	Single link that routes to all your platforms. Put in Instagram bio.	Set Up First

	Tool / Service	Why It Matters	Priority
	Fiverr or SoundBetter account	For when you want to hire an online mixer or session musician.	At Release